Overseas Newsletter

October 2010

Putting a face to the name…

Board of Trustees representative:
Eddie Hefferman



Overseas Administrator:
Nik Epton



Newsletter Editor:
Carolyn Garner



No more Legion*Letter*

LegionExtra and LegionLetter have now been discontinued. Your regular Branch documents will now be sent in a separate mail out.
In its place, we now have the Legion Magazine, which will be published six times a year (increased from four) and will accommodate some of the content from the discontinued publications.

Reminder to Branch Officers

Please be reminded that your branch returns must be received by Head Office no later than 4 January 2011. Please also be aware of the Christmas post backlog and send returns well in advance to avoid any possible delays.
If these returns are not received, your branch will not be eligible to send delegates to Annual Conference.

These documents include:

- Branch MS1's
- Branch Accounts
- Poppy Appeal Retention Scheme (SC22)

Online Joining

Online joining has been rolled out nationally in the UK mainland after a successful pilot with the Riders Branch.

Membership Statistics:

Overseas	
New :	14
Lapsed:	33
Total:	5675 (+2%)
North Spain	
New:	54
Lapsed	10
Total:	1677 (+2.7%)
South Spain:	
New:	23
Lapsed:	12
Total:	1857 (+.7)
Germany:	
New:	75
Lapsed:	14
Total:	2223 (+2.8)
Overall:	
New:	745
Lapsed	140
Total:	19598/ (+3.19)

Branch AGM's

Please be reminded that your Branch AGM's should be held between 1 October and30 November in accordance with your Branch Bye-Laws.

1921 Shoulder to Shoulder with all who serve 2011

Registered Charity: The Royal British Legion, 199 Borough High Street, London SE1 1AA
Registered Charity Number: 219279

THE ROYAL BRITISH LEGION

The way forward…

On 30 September 2010 at the Royal Albert Hall, the Director General and the National Chairman presented the new Legion vision for the future at the start of the 90th anniversary year.

The world is changing, the people we serve are changing, and the people who support us are changing, so we must change. Over the past 90 years we have grown. We are now more influential and touch more people's lives than ever. This is a wonderful privilege, but it could easily become a major problem unless we rise to these new challenges. So our 90th anniversary is much more than a time for celebration - it marks a major turning point in the way the Legion does its business and views its role in the decades ahead.

The Board of Trustees and the Executive Board have developed an exciting pathway for the Legion's future growth and the Legion has a new mission, to be:

The No.1 provider of welfare, comradeship, representation and Remembrance for the Armed Forces community.

Our new mission puts welfare at the heart of the Legion. We are developing a new welfare strategy, informed by a programme of research which is due to report in October. We'll be prioritising those services of most relevance to our beneficiaries and developing new services. We will extend our support for, and campaigning on behalf of, the Armed Forces and cultivate new communities of people to help us in our work. We will work with our members and supporters to reinforce a sense of shared purpose and comradeship.

The new mission is summarised by a new corporate strap line:

Shoulder to shoulder with all who Serve.

It will be our corporate mantra emphasizing that The Royal British Legion:

- Helps people to help themselves
- Is a proud advocate of everyone who serves
- Is united with its supporters in a common cause; and
- Values comradeship amongst its members and supporters.

We are starting by looking at the way the Legion is organised, from the top down. We're proposing some changes to the way the Board of Trustees is made up, and planning to strengthen the Membership Council so that it has responsibility for all membership policy matters.
We have also looked at our internal organisation. We are proposing some changes to our functional structure (our staffing structures), many of which we intend to have in place by 15 November.
We believe that one of the Legion's unique selling points is our presence in the community. We must not lose this. In fact, we want to make being a 'national organisation with local delivery' central to what we are.

All Branches will receive a briefing pack in the near future with extra information and articles will be published in *Legion* to keep you up to speed with new developments

Summary of the Presentation on the General Fund and Affiliation Fee

The following is a summary of the key points and numbers included in the presentation prepared by Director of Finance John Graham on the subject of the General Fund and Affiliation Fee. This presentation was given to attendees at the Way Forward regional seminars held during October and November 2010. Further information from the regional seminars will be circulated but in the meantime these numbers are provided for your use.

Headlines

- Membership is declining at 4% per year and forecast to accelerate.
- The current affiliation fee of £11 does not cover the cost of Membership. The budget for 2010/11 is based on a cost of £16 per member which would require an Affiliation Fee of £14.50 (taking Gift Aid into account).
- With the Affiliation fee remaining at £11, the General Fund by September 2011 will decrease by c.£1 million
- The current position is unsustainable. The affiliation fee needs to rise at Telford to at least £16 to cover immediate costs.
- The fall in membership will not allow the existing cost base to be sustained. If costs grow at inflation, the increased fee will need to double in four years.
- In any event, support costs will have to be further reduced to match the expected fall in Membership

Cost of Membership

Heading	**Budget 2011 £m**
Direct Field staff	1.3
Membership Directorate	1.6
Properties/Management	1.2
Magazine and other communication	1.0
Membership Administration	0.2
Annual Conference	0.3
Total	**5.6**

Impact on the Affiliation Fee if we do nothing

Year	Members ('000)	Fee (£)	Cost (£m)
2010	370	14.50	5.6
2011	320	16	5.7*
2012	268	20	5.9*
2013	218	25	6.0*
2014	167	33	6.2*

* Inflation at 2.5%

If we do nothing the affiliation Fee will have to rise to £33 if we are to cover costs. The costs of Membership cannot continue to increase as membership numbers reduce. We need to cut the cost of Membership

What costs do we have to cut?

Assume a fee of £16 at Telford plus agreement to increase in line with inflation.

Year	Members ('000)	Fee (£)	Income (£k)
2010	370	14.50	5.6
2011	320	16.00	5.7
2012	268	16.50*	4.9
2013	218	17.00*	4.1
2014	167	17.50*	3.2

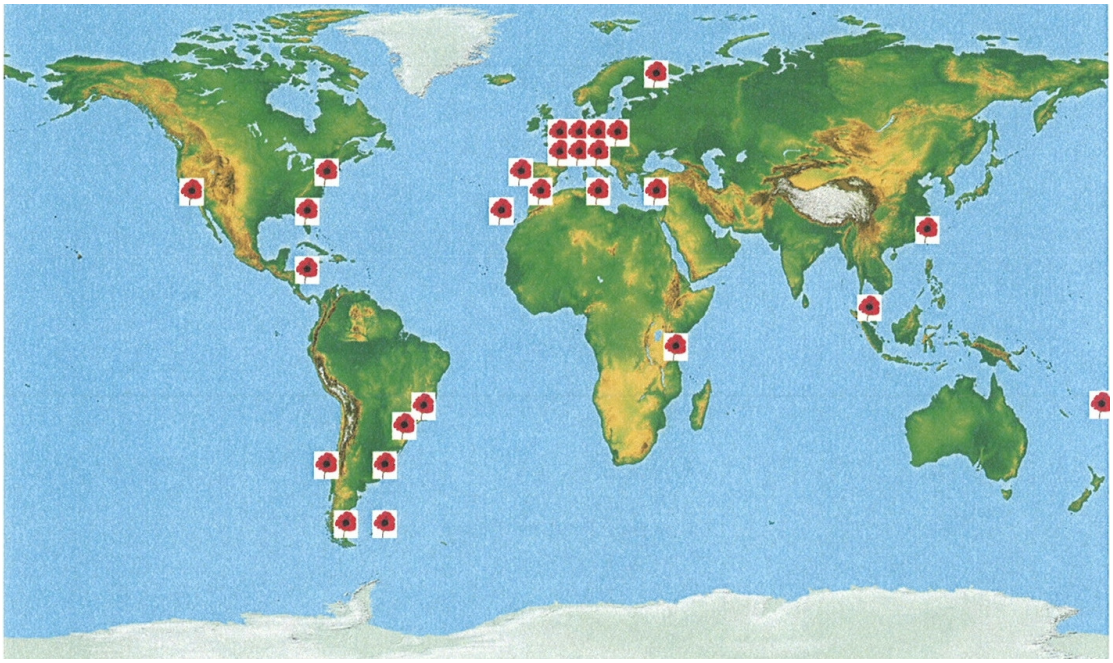
By 2014 we need to remove around £3 million of costs from the cost of membership. There will be less resources available to support the membership structure.

What happens if the Affiliation Fee stays at £11 after the Conference in Telford

In 2014 assuming the current Affiliation Fee rises in line with inflation to £12, on a membership of 167,000, membership income (including Gift aid) will be £2.2 million. If we are to make the Affiliation Fee cover the cost of membership, we will have to remove over £4 million from the cost of Membership.

If we have to cut £4 million out of a budget of around £6 million, by 2014 membership will cease to exist in the form that we know it.

Snap shot of RBL Branches Overseas



Overseas Branches:
(Under the administration of Head Office)

Africa:	Kenya
North/ Central America:	Belize
	U.S.A (3)
South America:	Buenos Aires
	Rio de Janeiro
	Santiago
	Sao Paulo
	Uruguayan
	Falkland Islands
Asia/Oceania:	Fiji
	Hong Kong
	Tokyo
	Thailand (2)
Europe:	Belgium (4)
	Cyprus (2)
	Channel Islands (5)
	France (10)
	Holland
	Malta
	Portugal
	Sweden
	Switzerland

Three District Committees:

1. **District Spain North (20 branches)**
2. **District Spain South (15 branches)**
3. **District Germany (15 branches)**